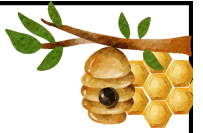


WELCOME TO MS. GEMENIANO'S KI HIVE

Buzz to School SY 2026-2027



Aloha and welcome to a brand-new school year! I'm so excited to be on this Kindergarten journey with you and your child. It's my favorite grade to teach, and I know this year will be full of growth, discovery, and lots of joyful learning. With us working together as a team, I'm confident it's going to be a great year.



SCHOOL MISSION: NUI

In Kindergarten, NUI looks like...

NURTURE	In our class, we nurture curiosity through hands-on activities, faith-filled moments, and daily opportunities to explore.
UNITE	We unite by working together on projects, celebrating each other's successes, and practicing kindness every day.
INSPIRE	We are inspired by encouraging new ideas, cheering on brave attempts, and showing that mistakes help us grow.

SCHOOL VISION: Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith

CONTACT INFORMATION:

- I can be reached by email at bgemeniano@starofthesea.org.
- I respond to emails during school hours, Monday-Friday, 7:30 a.m.-3:30 p.m.
- You may also send me a note in your child's [BEE Binder](#).
- A [weekly newsletter](#) will be sent home with classroom updates, what we're learning, important dates, and upcoming events.
- Throughout the year, I will also send [emails](#) with reminders, schedule changes, and follow-up information as needed.
- [Parent Pouch](#): Important school flyers and notices will be sent home every Tuesday. Please remove all contents and return the empty Parent Pouch on Wednesday.
- We will have two scheduled Parent-Teacher Conferences during the school year, held in the first and third quarters.

GRADING

I'll be checking daily classwork and homework for effort, thoroughness, and neatness. Writing assessments and class projects will be graded using rubrics. I also spend time one-on-one with students to formally assess their academic progress. Throughout the day, I use informal assessments to monitor each student's progress during a unit. At the end of a unit or topic, I'll conduct a summative assessment to evaluate overall progress and identify areas that may still require improvement. Report cards go out at the end of each quarter and are graded on a 1 to 4 scale:

Report cards are based on how your child performs each quarter. Grades are not reflected based on year-end benchmarks.

We will have two parent-teacher conferences this year, scheduled for the first and third quarters.

1 = Beginning

- The student is beginning to understand the concept or skill
- Requires significant support and guidance
- Limited understanding or mastery of the topic

2 = Developing

- The student demonstrates partial understanding or skill
- Needs occasional assistance or support, progressing but with notable gaps

3 = Proficient

- The student meets grade-level expectations
- Demonstrates a solid understanding of concepts or skills
- Works independently with minimal errors

4 = Mastery

- The student exceeds grade level expectations
- Demonstrates a thorough understanding and can apply skills in new situations
- Work is consistently accurate and shows a higher level of thinking

FAMILY TRIPS

If you are planning a family trip and your child will miss school, please inform the office and me as soon as possible. The homework will be the routine homework given every day. Your child will complete all the missed classwork after the trip.



BIRTHDAY PROTOCOLS

- We will sing *Happy Birthday*, and your child will receive a birthday crown on or near their special day.
- Please notify me **at least 1 week in advance** if you plan to send in a treat.
- **Cupcakes are not allowed** in Kindergarten this school year (per school handbook).
- All treats must be:
 - Delivered to the **front office** (not directly to the classroom)
 - **Store-bought, pre-packaged, and easy to distribute** (e.g., individually sealed)
 - **Nut-free** (no peanuts or tree nuts due to allergies)
- We encourage **non-food treats** like stickers, pencils, or small books.
- Treats will be handed out at the **end of the school day**.

BIRTHDAY INVITATIONS

Invitations may only be distributed at school if the whole class is invited. I'll be sending out a K1 family roster (with contact info that families have chosen to share) for any outside invitations.

TIME, TALENT, AND TREASURE

We value any talents you can share with our class! If you'd like to volunteer, please ensure your documentation is up to date with the office.

Ways You Can Help:

- Assist with classroom crafts, decorations, and event preparation.
- Chaperone field trips and special activities.
- Share a special skill, hobby, profession, or cultural tradition with our class.
- Contribute items from our classroom wish list or donate materials for classroom projects (*completely optional and never expected*).
- Help organize PTG-sponsored school events.
- Volunteer at school-wide events and activities.
- Assist in recruiting volunteers for school-wide events.

If you are interested in volunteering in our classroom or at school events, please email me. I would love to have your help!



Homework Routine & B.E.E. Binder (Bring Everything Everyday)



The B.E.E. Binder is your child's daily tool for organization and communication between home and school. It must be brought to school every day. Homework begins August 10 and is completed Monday-Thursday nights (none on Fridays or during long breaks).

Daily Homework

- **Kindergarten Sight Words:** At the beginning of the year, we will spend one week mastering each sight word. As students gain confidence, we will gradually increase the pace to one word every three days, every two days, or one word per day, depending on the word's difficulty and the class's readiness.

Please follow the Sight Word Calendar. Practice only the assigned word until all six words in that list have been mastered. The calendar will then indicate when to review and practice the entire list for fluency. Please avoid introducing future sight words early, as the sequence is designed to support long-term mastery.

- **Homework Packet** The weekly homework packet is located in the two-pocket folder inside your child's BEE Binder. It will be sent home every Monday and is due on Friday (or the last school day before a long break). The homework packet includes:
 - Cover sheet with weekly verbal practice and handwriting page suggestions.
 - Math pages
 - Phonics/Reading pages
- **Flashcards:** Flashcards are provided as a supplemental resource to practice:
 - Letter-sound correspondence
 - Identifying uppercase and lowercase letters
 - Sight words
 - Number recognition

Reading Folders

Students will also be receiving reading folders with books at their reading level. These will be sent home starting in September. Reading folders go home on Monday with books for the week. Books are to be returned in the reading folder at the end of the school week in order to get a new set of books on Monday.



WHAT'S INSIDE THE BEE BINDER



- **Sight Words & Calendar** – 66 sight words taught gradually throughout the year; home review is encouraged.
- **Book Pouch** – Nightly reading book.
- **“Bee”havior Buzz Calendar** – A daily color tracker of your child’s choices and behavior:
 - **Yellow** – Great choices throughout the day; positive role model.
 - **Green** – Good choices; met expectations.
 - **Red** – Needs improvement; follow-up at home or parent contact.

Note: For the first few weeks of school, I start students on green each day to encourage them to work toward yellow.
- **Handwriting Pages** – Inside a sheet protector; use with a dry-erase marker and erase after each use.
- **Flashcards (pencil case pouch)** – Letters, numbers, and sight words (sent gradually to avoid overwhelm).
- **Homework Packet** – Math and Phonics sheets; sent home Monday, due Friday.

“BEE”HAVIOR TRACKER

Our Beehavior Buzz Calendar reflects our mission to **Nurture, Unite, and Inspire**, and our vision to be **Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith**.

Expectations: Be Safe, Be Kind, Do Your Best, Make Christ-like Choices.

We celebrate positive choices daily and use logical consequences to help students learn from mistakes. Examples: practicing calm walking if running indoors, or cleaning up a mess if materials are used carelessly. I will contact you if extra support is needed so we can work together to guide your child’s growth.

KINDERGARTEN CURRICULUM

LANGUAGE ARTS
(SIGHT WORDS)



- First 66 Sight Words
from the Fry List
(Aligned with the From
Sounds to Spelling Program)





LANGUAGE ARTS (PHONICS)



- Materials: From Sounds to Spelling Phonics and Spelling Program
- Q1: Students' Names, Mm, Ss, Aa, Rr, Tt, Ll, Nn, Bb, Oo, Pp, Cc, Ii, Ff, Dd, Hh
- Q2: Uu, Gg, Kk, Ee, Vv, Xx, Jj, Ww, Yy, Qq, Zz, short vowels a and i; CVC words, e, o, u; CVC words, Digraphs sh, th, ch, wh
- Q3: Digraphs qu, ck, CVC words in the -at, -an, -am, -ap -op, -ot, -ob, -im, -ip, -in, -ill, -ug, -ut, -ed, -et word families
- Q4: Plural nouns and inflectional endings with -s, initial s-blends (st-, sp-, sm-, sn-, sw-, sc-, sk-, sl-), initial l-blends (bl-, cl-, fl-, gl- pl-), Initial r-blends (br-, cr-, dr-, fr-, gr-, pr-, tr-), SOUNDS of long a,e,i,o,u, CVCe words with long a and long o, CVCe words with long i and long u



LANGUAGE ARTS (READING AND WRITING)



- Q1: Exploring Letters and Sounds, Forming Words and Composing Stories
- Q2: Developing Reading Powers and Writing a Personal Story
- Q3: Pattern Power and Writing Our Opinion
- Q4: Becoming Avid Readers and Writing about a Topic

LANGUAGE ARTS (HANDWRITING)



- Materials: Zaner-Bloser Handwriting book
- basic strokes
- proper pencil grip and posture
- upper and lowercase letter formation
- writing numerals, and then applying our handwriting skills to our everyday classroom and home life

Phonics & Spelling Instruction

We use the *From Sounds to Spelling* program, a structured, research-based approach to building strong reading and spelling skills. Students move through a clear sequence of letter sounds, word patterns, and spelling rules, with daily practice in reading and writing to build confidence and accuracy.



SCIENCE



Q1: Engineering, Technology, and Applications of Science

- Scientific Method Engineering Design Process

Q2: Life Science

- Plants and Animals
- Resources in Environments

Q3: Earth and Space Science

- Weather and Climate

Q4: Physical Science

- Pushes and Pulls



SOCIAL STUDIES



Q1: Civics/History

- Learning and Working Together
- Time and Chronology

Q2: Geography

- Geography of the Neighborhood

Q3: Economics

- Work Now and Long Ago

Q4: History

- Learning About the Past
- National and State Symbols
- (Hawaiiiana Unit)



MATH



- Materials: Envision Math books, manipulatives, iPad, **Freckle**, dry-erase boards, Math journals
- Math Centers
- Numbers 0-20
- Rote counting to 100
- Classify & Count Data
- Understand Addition & Subtraction
- Addition and Subtraction to 10
- 2D and 3D Shapes
- Comparison of Length, Weight, Capacity



RELIGION



- Materials: Stories of God's Love book, journals, prayer corner
- God Creates the World
- God's Love Makes Me Who I Am
- God Gives Us Loving People
- Jesus Comes to Us
- Social Emotional Unit
- Celebrating Friendships
- Jesus Shares God's Love
- We Follow Jesus





TENTATIVE DAILY CLASS SCHEDULE

Below is what a typical day in Kindergarten looks like. There may be minor adjustments, especially during the first few weeks of school as we establish routines.

A copy of the finalized daily schedule will be kept in your child's BEE Binder for easy reference throughout the year. If the schedule changes, I will notify you by email and place an updated copy in your child's BEE Binder.

KI- Ms. Gemeniano Class Schedule 2026-2027

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
7:45-8:00	Morning Routine				7:55 walk to church
8:00-8:15	Morning Meeting				MASS 800 to 900
8:15-8:30	Language Arts Phonics, Sight Word, Reading, Writing, Handwriting	Language Arts Phonics, Sight Word, Reading, Writing, Handwriting	Language Arts Phonics, Sight Word, Reading, Writing, Handwriting	Language Arts Phonics, Sight Word, Reading, Writing, Handwriting	
8:30-9:35					FRECKLE/LALILO
9:35-9:55	Snack/Recess				
10:00-10:50	MUSIC 10-10:50	Math	Math	ART 1000-10: 50	Language Arts Phonics, Sight Word, Reading, Writing, Handwriting
10:45-11:15	Math	Math	Math	Math	
11:15-12:10	Lunch/Recess				
12:10- 12:35	QUIET TIME ON MAT				
12:35-1:00	Religion	Religion	Religion	Religion	Math
1:00-1:45	PE 1:05-1:35	Science/ Social Studies	PE 1:05-1:35	Science/ Social Studies	Math
1:45- 2:15	Science/ Social Studies	SEL/ GI Health 1:45-12:15	Science/ Social Studies	FRECKLE/LALILO	LIBRARY 2-2:30
2:15	Pack-up, (line-up and walk to autoline by 2:25)				
2:30	Kindergarten Dismissal				

7/28/2026

